1. Scope, eligibility and approval limits

1.1 This policy covers reasonable business purchases made by employees of Aster Vale Works Pvt. Ltd. for an assigned work purpose. Consultants and agency workers use the reimbursement terms in their engagement agreement. A purchase must have a clear business purpose, be within an approved budget and be supported by an itemized receipt. Personal costs, fines, penalties, alcohol and costs for a companion are not reimbursable.

1.2 Obtain written approval before committing company funds. Approval authority is based on the total price including taxes and delivery for one item or one related purchase:

Approver	Maximum per purchase
Direct manager	INR 15,000
Department head	INR 75,000
Finance Director	Above INR 75,000, within approved budget

1.3 A purchase above INR 15,000 requires department-head approval; above INR 75,000 also requires Finance Director approval. The Finance Director cannot approve spending outside an approved budget; a budget change must be recorded first. Dividing one order into smaller invoices to avoid an approval limit is prohibited. A purchase with no written pre-approval is normally declined.

1.4 The approver checks business purpose, budget, price reasonableness and whether an existing company asset can be used. Approval must identify the item or trip, expected total and cost center. A chat message is acceptable only if it clearly records these details and is retained with the claim. Silence, a verbal suggestion or an approved purchase order for a different item is not approval.

1.5 Emergency safety purchases may be made only to prevent immediate harm or material damage. Notify the department head as soon as safe and submit the receipt and explanation within two working days. The emergency route does not authorize personal purchases, bypass the Finance Director's budget control or guarantee reimbursement.

2. Travel, meals and local transport

2.1 Obtain manager approval before booking business travel and include destination, dates, business purpose and estimated total. Air travel must be economy class and booked through the designated travel desk where available. Rail travel should use the lowest practical class that meets the schedule. A more expensive option requires department-head approval before booking and an explanation of the time or accessibility need.

2.2 For approved domestic travel, lodging is reimbursable up to INR 6,000 per night before taxes, and meals up to INR 1,200 per travel day. These are per-employee limits, not cash allowances. Submit the actual itemized cost; unused limits are not paid. A client-hosted meal counts toward the meal limit and must list attendees and business purpose. Alcohol is never reimbursable.

2.3 Local public transport and app-based rides may be claimed at actual cost when used for an approved business trip. Choose a reasonable route and attach the receipt or trip record. Personal detours, commuting between home and the assigned office, traffic fines and vehicle damage are not reimbursable. A private vehicle requires prior manager approval and a route record; mileage is reimbursed at the rate shown in the current Finance Desk schedule.

2.4 When travel plans change, tell the manager and travel desk as soon as possible. Cancellation charges caused by a company schedule change may be claimed with the original approval and revised itinerary. Charges caused by a personal change are not covered. If an employee combines personal days with a business trip, claim only the cost that would have applied to the business itinerary.

2.5 A trip estimate exceeding INR 15,000 follows the approval table in section 1 before booking. A likely total above INR 75,000 requires department-head and Finance Director approval. Do not assume that approval of the trip purpose also approves an over-limit hotel, fare or itinerary change.

3. Claims, evidence and payment deadlines

3.1 Submit an expense claim in the Finance Desk portal within 30 calendar days after the purchase or the final day of a trip, whichever applies. Each line must show date, merchant, amount, currency, cost center and a short business purpose. Attach an itemized receipt and the pre-approval. A card slip without item details is not sufficient when an itemized receipt is available.

3.2 If a receipt is genuinely unavailable, submit a missing-receipt declaration within the same 30-day period. State the merchant, date, amount, items and reason the receipt cannot be obtained. The manager and Finance Desk must approve the declaration. Claims above INR 2,000 without a receipt need department-head approval as well. Repeated missing receipts may result in refusal and a review of purchasing access.

3.3 Claims in foreign currency must include the original currency and amount. Finance converts the approved amount using the corporate card settlement rate or, for a personal card, the exchange rate shown on the card statement. Add the statement line with unrelated transactions redacted. Do not claim a separate conversion fee unless it appears on the statement and was incurred for the approved purchase.

3.4 The manager reviews a complete claim within five working days. Finance checks policy, receipt and budget within five further working days. If information is missing, the claim returns to the employee with a reason; the review clock restarts when the requested information is supplied. Finance pays an approved complete claim within 15 working days, subject to the regular payment cycle.

3.5 Claims submitted after 30 calendar days need a written reason and department-head approval; Finance may reject a late claim. No claim may be altered to hide a personal item or split a purchase. Keep original receipts until payment is confirmed. Questions on status, currency conversion or a missing receipt go to finance@astervaleworks.example.

4. Exceptions, prohibited claims and contacts

4.1 An exception to a stated meal or lodging cap must be approved by the department head before the expense is incurred. A total purchase above INR 75,000 also requires Finance Director approval under section 1. Explain the business reason and show the expected cost. An exception cannot authorize a prohibited item, unbudgeted spending or a purchase split to avoid controls.

4.2 The following are not claimable: personal shopping, home internet and electricity under the Remote Work Policy, normal commuting, gifts to public officials, alcohol, traffic or parking fines, late fees caused by personal delay, and costs for family or other companions. A customer meal may be claimed only within the INR 1,200 per-person travel-day meal limit and must record attendees, business purpose and the total amount.

4.3 Report a duplicate charge, mistaken reimbursement or suspected false receipt to finance@astervaleworks.example within two working days of discovery. Do not submit a second claim while the first is pending. Finance will advise whether to repay, correct or attach the item to an existing claim. Employees must cooperate with a reasonable audit and provide the approval, itinerary or original receipt requested.

4.4 Managers must not approve their own claim. The next-level manager approves a manager's claim, and the department head approves the next-level manager's claim. The Finance Director's own claim is reviewed by the Managing Director. Finance may hold a claim that lacks an independent approval and notify the employee of the missing reviewer.

4.5 For claim submission and payment questions, contact finance@astervaleworks.example. For a suspected misuse or pressure to bypass approval, report to the People Operations Director at people@astervaleworks.example or use the confidential concern channel in the Code of Conduct. Retaliation for raising a good-faith concern is prohibited.